

AI-Designed Drug Reverses Aging Markers as OpenAI's Agents Hit a 3-to-1 Research Pace

TL;DR

- ▶ An AI-designed lung drug from Insilico Medicine read as biologically younger across all six independent aging clocks tested in a Phase 2 trial, one of the strongest signals yet that AI drug discovery has real anti-aging side effects.
- ▶ OpenAI says its coding agents now produce 3.1 workdays of research output per 1 human workday, at \$600 to \$7,000/day in token costs, hitting Sam Altman's 'automated research intern' milestone right on his September target.
- ▶ GPT-6 Astra scored 99.9% on the ARC-AGI-3 benchmark under OpenAI's own setup but only 62.7% under a stripped-down configuration, the same model producing wildly different results depending on scaffolding.

AI TIPS

use AI better — how to do it

Build your own AI benchmark before trusting a vendor's

1. Pick one real task you actually need done, not a generic demo.
2. Run it through the new model and your current tool side by side.
3. Score both on: did it finish correctly, how many manual corrections it needed, total time, and actual cost.
4. Don't assume faster-but-sloppier automatically beats slower-but-right.

Source: The Neuron

Turn an app idea into a working prototype with Codex's /plan

1. Pick a workflow idea you want to test, like an internal tool, tracker, or small automation.
2. Open Codex, select Astra, and run /plan to get a requirements doc, asking it to pose multiple-choice questions to nail down details.
3. Request four design mockups (desktop and mobile) and pick a direction.
4. Have it build the chosen design, then test by adding data, reloading, and switching users to confirm it actually saves and shares.

Source: The Rundown AI

AI NEWS

the news — then what it means for you

An AI-designed drug shows signs of reversing biological aging. Insilico Medicine re-ran blood samples from its 12-week Phase 2a trial of rentosertib, an AI-designed drug for the lung-scarring disease idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis, through six independent aging-clock models; all six read patients as biologically younger, with some measures showing 3-6 years of apparent reversal at the four-week mark. Researchers caution the clocks can't fully separate slower aging from disease improvement.

What it means for you: A concrete data point for any client conversation about AI's ROI in biotech and pharma R&D, worth having on hand as more than a hypothetical.

Source: The Neuron, The Rundown AI, 1440 Daily Digest

OpenAI says its coding agents now out-produce human researchers 3-to-1. Internal data shows agents logging 3.1 workdays of output per 1 human workday, with typical researchers spending \$600+/day on agent tokens (90th percentile: \$7,000+/day) and token output up 124x since December; OpenAI calls it the 'automated research intern' milestone Sam Altman targeted for this month.

What it means for you: If OpenAI's own researchers are burning thousands a day per person on agent tokens, budget conversations with clients piloting agentic workflows need real cost guardrails, not just productivity promises.

Source: The Rundown AI

Nearly 130,000 tech jobs have disappeared in 2026 so far, with AI cited as a driver. Uber, PayPal, Oracle, and Apple have all pointed to AI-driven restructuring in recent job cuts.

What it means for you: A running tally worth tracking for client workforce-planning conversations, the number to have ready when someone asks whether this is actually happening at scale.

Source: The Neuron

GPT-6 Astra's benchmark score swung from 99.9% to 62.7% depending on setup. The model aced ARC-AGI-3 at 99.9% under OpenAI's own scaffolding, but when ARC Prize ran the same model with a stripped-down configuration, the score dropped to 62.7%, same model, different harness, very different result.

What it means for you: Vendor-reported benchmarks are only as good as the scaffolding behind them, worth a caveat any time a client cites a headline AI benchmark number.

Source: The Neuron, The Rundown AI, Morning Brew, 1440 Daily Digest (Sep 8). Newsletter links are click-tracked, so titles are cited rather than raw URLs.

Gas hit a record price for Labor Day. The national average hit \$4.15/gallon on Labor Day per AAA, the first time it's topped \$4 on that holiday; diesel spiked to a record \$5.85/gallon, driven partly by Iran's disruption of Strait of Hormuz tanker traffic and Ukrainian drone strikes on Russian refineries.

PM angle: Fuel and logistics costs are a real line item in any client's operating budget right now, worth flagging before it shows up as a surprise in a Q3 review.

Conversation starter: *Anyone else's travel or shipping costs jump this month? Gas just hit a Labor Day record.*

Source: Morning Brew, 1440 Daily Digest

A 22-year-old faces a plea hearing over a \$240M+ bitcoin heist. Malone Lam and 17 accomplices allegedly used 'vishing,' fake security-warning phone calls, to steal a victim's wallet credentials, then spent the proceeds on luxury cars, private jets, and nightclubs, reportedly \$569K in one night.

PM angle: A vivid, concrete example for any client's security-awareness training, vishing works because it sounds exactly like a legitimate fraud alert.

Conversation starter: *Have you seen the \$240M crypto vishing case? Worth using as a real example next time we talk security awareness training.*

Source: 1440 Daily Digest

Jaguar Land Rover is cutting 4,000 jobs, about 10% of its workforce. The cuts, over two years, come amid intensifying competition from Chinese EV makers and the effects of Trump-era tariffs.

PM angle: A live case study for clients in automotive or manufacturing on how tariff exposure and low-cost competition are forcing workforce decisions.

Conversation starter: *JLR just cut 4,000 jobs citing Chinese EV competition and tariffs, is that pressure showing up in any of our clients' sectors yet?*

Source: Morning Brew, 1440 Daily Digest

An Amazon cargo plane crash in Miami killed at least 5 people. The Boeing 767, operated by contractor 21 Air, overshot the runway by roughly 1,300 feet and crossed a public road; Miami's airport lacks the 'crushable arresting system' now installed at 70 other airports.

PM angle: No direct relevance to your work, general awareness only.

Conversation starter: *Did you see the Amazon cargo plane crash in Miami? The airport apparently didn't have the runway safety system most others do now.*

Source: Morning Brew, 1440 Daily Digest

Germany's far-right AfD won a landslide state election in Saxony-Anhalt. It's the party's first shot at leading a state government since the Nazi era; Germany's intelligence agency classifies AfD as extremist in some regions.

PM angle: No direct relevance to your work, general awareness only.

Conversation starter: *Did you catch that Germany's AfD just won a state election outright? Worth watching if it changes the EU regulatory conversation.*

Source: Morning Brew